SADC HUMANITARIAN AND EMERGENCY OPERATIONS CENTRE

TRAINING MANUAL

Business Continuity Management

BCM Plan and SOPs 9.1–9.7 | B1–B9 Touchpoints | UNDAC ERT Mission Cycle

Based on BCM Plan Version 3.0 — ISO 22301:2019 Aligned

Classification:	RESTRICTED
Version:	1.0
Effective Date:	April 2026
SOP Reference:	BCM Plan v3.0 (SOPs 9.1–9.7)
BCM Codes:	B1–B9 (Critical Functions through Records Continuity)
Target Audience:	All SHOC Staff (Posts 1–23), DIMAG Members, Continuity Leads

Benchmarked: ISO 22301:2019 | ISO 31000:2018 | UNDAC 8th Ed. | IFRC Surge Toolbox | SADC DRMSS

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This Training Manual is a companion to the SHOC Business Continuity Management Plan, Version 3.0 (SOPs 9.1–9.7). It provides all SHOC staff (Posts 1–23), DIMAG members, and Continuity Leads with practical guidance on maintaining critical operations during disruptions and restoring full capability within defined RTO/RPO targets.

Core BCM principle: SHOC must continue delivering critical, life-saving regional coordination services during disruptions. The BCM Plan ensures minimum operational capability across Early Warning, Operations, ICT, Finance, and Logistics through nine objectives (B1–B9) implemented via seven SOPs (9.1–9.7).

Governance: BCM Sponsor: Executive Director. BCM Owner: Head of Operations. The Disaster Management Advisory Group (DIMAG) — comprising ED, HoO, HoP, and Technical Continuity Leads — convenes automatically at Alert phase and remains in session through Recovery.

2. Terms and Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form
BCM	Business Continuity Management
BGYOR	Blue, Green, Yellow, Orange, Red — Risk scale
DIMAG	Disaster Management Advisory Group
MBCO	Minimum Business Continuity Objective
OSOCC	On-Site Operations Coordination Centre
RPO	Recovery Point Objective
RTO	Recovery Time Objective
SHOC	SADC Humanitarian and Emergency Operations Centre
SPOF	Single Point of Failure

3. BCM Lifecycle and B1–B9 Objectives

3.1 Five-Phase BCM Lifecycle

Phase	Trigger	BCM Priority	Key Actions
Preparedness	Normal operations	Maintain readiness	Monitor systems; maintain roster; quarterly drills
Alert	Threshold exceeded	Pre-activation	Convene DIMAG; verify RTO/RPO readiness; pre-alert staff
Activation	Confirmed	Deploy and switch	Activate Botswana OSOCC; deploy staff; switch to redundant systems
Operations	Full crisis	All mechanisms active	Full OSOCC; 24/7 operations; regional partner activation
Recovery	Crisis subsiding	Restore and learn	Restore primary; reconcile data/assets; AAR; welfare debrief

3.2 B1–B9 BCM Objectives

Code	Objective	Key SOP
B1	Maintain continuity of critical functions	SOPs 9.1–9.7 + all operational SOPs
B2	Deliver MBCOs at each lifecycle phase	Section 6.2 MBCO Table
B3	Restore critical functions within defined RTO	SOP 9.3
B4	Ensure data losses never exceed RPO thresholds	SOP 9.3
B5	Activate alternate sites within 2 hours	SOP 9.4
B6	Identify and mitigate SPOFs	SOP 9.2
B7	Ensure alignment with NDMA–SADC–IFRC–UN partners	SOP 9.6
B8	Maintain minimum staffing and succession	SOP 9.7
B9	Protect all SHOC operational records	SOP 9.3

4. Critical Functions and RTO/RPO Targets

4.1 Eight Critical Functions

Priority	Function	BCM Continuity Lead	RTO	RPO
1	Early Warning and Monitoring	EW Officer (Post 5)	0 hours	15 minutes
2	Emergency Operations Coordination	Head of Operations (Post 3)	1 hour	30 minutes
3	Information Management and SITREPs	IM Officer (Post 6)	1 hour	30 minutes
4	Emergency Telecommunications and ICT	ICT Officer (Post 9)	2 hours	1 hour
5	Supply Chain and Logistics	SCM Officer (Post 7)	2 hours	2 hours
6	Finance and Administration	Finance Officer (Post 8)	12 hours	1 hour
7	Communications and Public Information	Comms Officer (Post 10)	4 hours	2 hours
8	Security and Access Control	Head of Operations (Post 3)	1 hour	N/A

4.2 MBCOs by Phase

Function	Alert	Activation	Operations	Recovery
Early Warning	2-hour threshold confirm	Hourly updates	Real-time feeds	Verify data integrity
Operations	Convene DIMAG	Deploy ERTs	Full OSOCC	AAR; demobilise
ICT	Enable backups	Activate redundancy	Virtual OSOCC	Restore primary
Logistics	Pre-positioning	Asset deployment	Regional mobilisation	Reconcile assets
Finance	Pre-authorisation	Emergency funds	24-hour treasury	Reconcile; audit
IM/SITREP	6-hour cycle	3-hour cycle	1-hour cycle	Final SITREP; archive
Security	Yellow (elevated)	Orange (restricted)	Red (lockdown)	Audit logs; restore

4.3 Trainer's Notes

Critical learning: Trainees must memorise the RTO/RPO for the top 3 critical functions: EW (0hr/15min), Operations (1hr/30min), IM (1hr/30min). Test with a scenario: "The primary SHOC centre loses all connectivity at 10:00. At what time must EW feeds be restored? At what time must the Operations function be operational from an alternate site?"

5. SOP 9.1: BCM Roles and Responsibilities

ISO Reference: Clause 5.3

SOP 9.1 assigns BCM responsibilities to every SHOC staff role (Posts 1–23) across all five lifecycle phases. Key role assignments:

Post	Role	BCM Role	Key BCM Responsibilities
1	Executive Director	BCM Sponsor	Approves Plan and activation; authorises alternate site and emergency procurement; succession
3	Head of Operations	BCM Owner	Leads activation; ensures RTO/MBCO compliance; leads Operational Continuity Cell; SPOF mitigation
5	EW&M Officer	EW Continuity Lead	24/7 monitoring continuity; RTO 0hrs/RPO 15min; backup feeds at alternate site
6	IM & Reporting	IM Continuity Lead	SITREP continuity; dashboards and geo-redundancy; Virtual OSOCC support
9	ICT Officer	ICT Continuity Lead	All digital systems within RTO/RPO; failover activation; cybersecurity; backups
7	SCM Officer	Logistics Lead	Supply chain continuity; alternate routes; multi-vendor; asset records
8	Finance Officer	Financial Lead	Emergency financing continuity; RTO 12hrs/RPO 1hr; mobile workflows

6. SOP 9.2: Risk Matrix and SPOF Assessment

ISO Reference: Clause 6.1, 8.2

6.1 BCM Risk Register (Top Risks)

Risk	Inherent	Residual	Key Mitigation
ICT Infrastructure Failure	Red	Yellow	Cloud failover; dual ISP; satellite; Virtual OSOCC; hourly backups
AMHEWAS / EW Outage	Red	Orange	Redundant feeds; IFRC/INGD backup; manual verification
Data Corruption / Cyber	Red	Yellow	Scans; encryption; geo-redundancy; zero-trust
Records Loss	Red	Yellow	Hourly snapshots; encrypted cloud; off-site archives
Staff Unavailability	Orange	Yellow	Succession; cross-training; minimum staffing; remote work
Supply Chain Breakdown	Orange	Yellow	Multi-vendor; INGD corridor; pre-positioning; WFP/IFRC
Finance System Failure	Orange	Yellow	Mobile approvals; delegated authority; cloud systems

6.2 SPOF Register (Key SPOFs)

SPOF Area	Description	Risk	Mitigation
Single ISP	SHOC relies on one fibre route	Red	Dual ISP + satellite + offline templates
AMHEWAS Node	Central node failure stops EW	Red	Redundant nodes with IFRC/INGD
Power Supply	Building without generator redundancy	Red	Dual generators + UPS + solar
Single Finance Signatory	Delays crisis procurement	Orange	Delegated authority + mobile approval
ICT Officer Bottleneck	Failure affects entire digital system	Orange	Asst ICT + alternates per SOP 9.7
Single Logistics Vendor	Transport shutdown halts response	Orange	Multi-vendor; INGD corridor

7. SOP 9.3: Data Backup and ICT Continuity

ISO Reference: Clause 8.1, A.17

7.1 Backup Frequency by Criticality

Tier	Systems	RPO	Backup Method
Critical (Hourly)	EW, IM dashboards, ICT core, Logistics, Ops/ERT	≤1 hr	Automated hourly to cloud; satellite uplink
Essential (6-Hour)	Communications, HR, routine files	≤6 hrs	Six-hour cloud replication
Financial (Daily)	Treasury, procurement, approvals, donor data	≤24 hrs	Encrypted daily to cloud; offline at alternate
Immutable (Daily)	Legal/audit records, compliance	Permanent	Encrypted offline; multi-region cold archives

7.2 Failover Sequence

Step	Action	Trigger	Time Target
1	ICT Officer declares failover	ICT failure / connectivity loss / cyber-attack / facility loss	Immediate
2	Switch to satellite uplink	Terrestrial connectivity down	Within 15 min
3	Activate primary cloud node	Satellite link established	Within 30 min
4	Launch Virtual OSOCC	Cloud operational	Within 1 hour
5	Resume SITREP cycle	Virtual OSOCC active	Within 60 min
6	Full restoration when safe	Disruption resolved	Per RTO; validate integrity

8. SOP 9.4: Alternate Site (OSOCC) Activation

ISO Reference: Clause 8.3, 8.5

Three-tier site hierarchy: Tier 1 — Botswana OSOCC (primary physical failover). Tier 2 — Virtual OSOCC (regional cloud). Tier 3 — Local secondary sites in Member States. Activation triggers: facility inaccessible, ICT outage, security/health danger, capacity overload. Target: activation within 2 hours.

Step	Action	Responsible	Time
1	Confirm trigger (facility/ICT/security/health)	HoO, ICT, EWMO	10 min
2	Declare activation phase	ED / HoO	30 min
3	Activate Botswana OSOCC	ICT, IMRO, EWMO	2 hours
4	Satellite-to-cloud failover	ICT / Asst ICT	2 hours
5	Re-establish operational cycles	All leads	4 hours
6	Maintain continuity	All leads	Continuous
7	Restore primary (Recovery)	ICT / HoO	Per RTO

8.1 Minimum Staffing at Botswana OSOCC

Alert: 4 staff (ICT, EW, IM, Operations). Activation: 8 staff (adds Logistics, Finance, Comms). Operations: 14–17 staff (full capability + 12-hour shifts). Pre-deployment stress screening per HR SOP 5.3 is mandatory.

9. SOP 9.5: Communication Tree and Escalation

ISO Reference: Clause 7.4, 8.4.3

Tier	Layer	Composition	Triggers
1	Operational	EW, IM, ICT, Programme, SCM, Finance, Comms, Translators, Secretary, Drivers	All disruptions; Preparedness/Alert
2	SHOC Management	ED, Head of Operations, Head of Programmes	Alert decisions; Activation/Operations declarations
3	Governing Board	Senior SADC officials; NDMA reps; IFRC/OCHA observers	Activation/Operations; multi-country hazards
4	Council of Ministers	Political executive layer	Operations-phase regional declarations

9.1 Communication Cycle by Phase

Preparedness: daily EW update to ED/HoO. Alert: 3-hour internal updates; SITREPs every 6 hours; verification to Governing Board. Activation: 2-hour internal; SITREPs every 3 hours; formal GB/SADC/NDMA/IFRC/OCHA notification. Operations: hourly command updates; SITREPs every hour; daily Council of Ministers briefing. Recovery: daily stand-down updates; final SITREP; AAR scheduling.

10. SOP 9.6: Cross-Organisational Dependencies

Dependency	Key Partners	Continuity Mechanism
Regional Governance	SADC Secretariat; Governing Board; Council of Ministers	Secure virtual channels; cloud OSOCC
EW & Hazard Data	INGD; IFRC; NDMAs; GDACS; WMO	Backup EW nodes; redundant feeds
Logistics & Corridors	Nacala Corridor; WFP; UNHCR/IOM	Multi-vendor; INGD corridor; pre-positioning
ICT & Cloud	Botswana OSOCC; SADC Cloud; Telecom vendors	Dual ISP; satellite; multi-region cloud
Response & Surge	IFRC Surge; UN OCHA/UNDAC; AUC-DREA	IFRC backup responder; UNDAC support
Financial & Admin	SADC Finance; State ministries; auditors	Cloud treasury; virtual approvals

11. SOP 9.7: Staff Succession Matrix

ISO Reference: Clause 7.2

Succession activates automatically when a role holder is unavailable for >2 hours during Activation or Operations.

Role	Primary	1st Alternate	2nd Alternate
Executive Director	ED	Head of Operations	Head of Programmes
Head of Operations	HoO	Head of Programmes	Programme Officer
EW&M Officer	EWMO	Senior EW Assistant	Head of Programmes
IM & Reporting	IMRO	Programme Officer	EW Officer
ICT Officer	ICT Officer	Asst ICT	IMRO
SCM Officer	SCMO	Logistics Assistant	Finance Officer
Finance Officer	FAO	Asst Finance	Asst HR & Admin
Comms Officer	Comms	Translator (FR/PT)	IMRO

Testing: quarterly tabletop; monthly shadowing; bi-annual full simulation. Combined roles apply at Botswana OSOCC: OSOCC Duty Manager (HoO→HoP→PO), Satellite-Cloud ICT Lead (ICT→Asst ICT), EW Lead (EWMO→Senior EW Asst), IM/SITREP Lead (IMRO→PO), Finance Lead (FAO→Asst Fin), Logistics Lead (SCMO→Logistics Asst), Communications Lead (Comms→Translators).

12. Monitoring, Testing and Continuous Improvement

12.1 KPIs

KPI	Indicator	Frequency
BCM Drill Completion	% of quarterly drills completed across all functions	Quarterly
RTO Compliance	% of critical functions restored within RTO during drills	Per activation
SPOF Closure Rate	% of identified SPOFs with implemented mitigations	Bi-annually
Succession Readiness	% of critical roles with trained/tested alternates	Bi-annually
Alternate Site Readiness	Botswana OSOCC tested and operational	Bi-annually
Data Backup Success	% of scheduled backups completed without error	Monthly
Staff Welfare Compliance	% of post-activation welfare debriefs within 14 days	Per activation

12.2 Testing Schedule

Activity	Frequency	Participants
ICT failover drill (satellite→cloud)	Quarterly	ICT, EW, IM

Succession tabletop exercise	Quarterly	All leads
Communication tree test	Quarterly	All staff
Botswana OSOCC simulation (full Activation)	Bi-annually	All + NDMA + IFRC
Full BCM Plan review	Annually	DIMAG + all leads
Cross-organisational BCM drill	Annually	SHOC + NDMAs + IFRC
Post-activation AAR	Within 72 hours	All involved

13. Assessment and Competency Verification

Competency	Assessment Method	Minimum Standard
B1–B9 objectives identification	Written test: match 9 codes to objectives	All 9 correct
RTO/RPO targets for top 3 functions	Timed scenario: identify restoration deadlines	EW 0hr/15min; Ops 1hr/30min; IM 1hr/30min
BCM incident response (10-step)	SIMEX: execute full sequence from detection to AAR	Correct sequence; all time targets met
DIMAG convening and escalation	Scenario: convene DIMAG from Alert trigger	Convened within 30 min; correct composition
Failover sequence execution	Practical: execute 6-step failover per SOP 9.3	Satellite within 15min; Virtual OSOCC within 1hr
Botswana OSOCC activation	Scenario: activate alternate site per SOP 9.4	Activated within 2hr target; minimum staffing correct
Communication tree by phase	Test: execute communication cascade for Operations phase	All 4 tiers notified; correct SITREP frequency
SPOF identification and mitigation	Present 5 systems; identify SPOFs	All SPOFs identified; correct mitigations cited
Succession chain application	Scenario: key role holder unavailable	Correct alternate activated within 2hr
Cross-organisational dependency mapping	Map 6 dependencies with partners and mechanisms	All 6 correct with continuity mechanism

Certification requirement: All SHOC staff must demonstrate competency in B1–B9 objectives and their specific BCM role responsibilities. DIMAG members and Continuity Leads must additionally pass the failover, OSOCC activation, and succession exercises. Quarterly drills, bi-annual OSOCC simulations, and annual cross-organisational exercises provide the primary assessment vehicles. Results feed into the BCM risk register and staff development plans.

— END OF TRAINING MANUAL —